



r/vrbohosts • 4mo ago

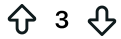
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For hosts using smart locks (Schlage, Yale, August or...):

Have you ever had a guest **struggle to get in** (even briefly)?

What did you do to fix it in the moment?



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theLastDanc3 • 4mo ago

Schlage- hands down the best.



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Reply



goFundmePI • 4mo ago

Unlock from my phone.

I did have the touch screen Kwikset lock and it was always confusing the older guests. I recently just swapped it with the actual button one and I think that will solve the problem



goFundmePI • 4mo ago

But yes do have a lockbox with all door keys in aswell but never needed it

quickly. So I use the basic and back it up with a key in a small Master lockbox. About 1 guest in 10 needs the lockbox. I have found real estate agents are the least competent with electronic locks. Go figure.



ATK10999 • 4mo ago

Yes, guests regularly have difficulties with the Eufy smartlock we use. First they mistake the backup lockbox for the deadbolt. Then they put in the code and forget to depress the checkmark  button. Only had one guest whose code just didn't work until I reprogrammed it.



ATK10999 • 4mo ago

Sometimes I open the deadbolt for them. Otherwise they finally figure it out. Just takes a while.



bloatedbeached_whale • 4mo ago • Edited 4mo ago

We have a pretty basic Schlage that is manual in that you need to turn a knob. It doesn't do it for you.

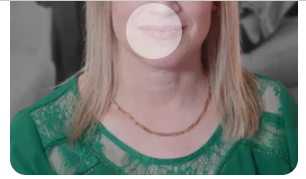
On the day of check-in, I text AND email a photo of an instruction card I made by scanning in a page from the Manual that shows step by step what to do.

I have a set number of codes I cycle through so I have a few cards made up that has the code right on it. Then I wipe it out post stay (reuse on a different week the next year).

One time I had a renters son unable to figure it out, but he called me and I walked him through it. These were Kind of a nightmare renter as I recall, so it's not usually an issue for me.

I've been doing it this way for 10 years.

FYI -I have a Bluetooth Kwickset on my main home that I bought about 4 or 5 years ago. It matched the design of the main handle better. Anyway, I've had weird issues where randomly it won't open and I had to resort to my key to open. At one time it just wouldn't open for 2 weeks. Then randomly started working again when was going to call tech support for a replacement. So if you go with that brand make sure you have an easy way to get a key to the renter if it fails.

[Learn More](#)[spectrum.com](#)**sal_helps** • 4mo ago

Assume it will happen and plan for it.

Talk them through it in real time since it's usually user error. Always have a backup entry like a lockbox or physical key. Send very clear check-in instructions, call out common mistakes, and test the code before arrival. That's what prevents lock issues from turning into bad reviews.

**RedBarchetta1** • 4mo ago

Schlage. The only time it happened was with a VRBO guest where I had to manually program the code in my phone and I had made a typo during code entry. I let her in immediately using the unlock feature on my phone and then reprogrammed with the correct code.

**awwgoogliebear** • 4mo ago

Yale...we havent had any problems in the 3 years we have had it. I'm prerry specific in instructions to guests and haven't had any guest delays. If by chance it happens, open it remotely for them so they can gain entry immediately and then provide further education.

**ATK10999** • 4mo ago

The Eufy ran fine for a few months but is now having problems. Won't display the codes anymore and is difficult to enter new one. Appears I need to replace it. Too bad, Eufy has a new one that reads palms rather than fingerprints that I like. But Eufy quality is in question. Only worked for 6 months.

**crzylilredhead** • 4mo ago

Lockly and never had any problems other than user error because people don't read

**Paceryder** • 4mo ago



sheroxxoxo • 4mo ago

I use Eufy in my STRs and my home. Airbnb doesn't yet offer link to their app, I use it to set personalized codes for guests' length of stay (can be set right down to time of day/night). I can add as many codes as needed, delete them as desired and remotely control if anyone needs help when at door (hasn't happened) but is great for workers who need entry but don't wish to grant independent access. It's less expensive and doesn't get scratches and fade like Yale and Schlage do. Additionally, it gives a warning for low battery and I've never had an issue. I have the basic model without fingerprint or camera, just touchscreen and there's a backup key (never used it), I installed unit each myself. Highly recommend.



r1ngr • 4mo ago

I include instructions for the keypad in my welcome email just in case people have problems. The only issues I've had with guests have been my fault - forgot to set the code or selected the wrong date.

I also keep a physical key in a lockbox on the property as an option of last resort



ChristinaWSalemOR • 4mo ago

There's always someone who can't operate a door knob, let alone a smart lock.



Smharman • 4mo ago

Yale and I only had one guest who had problems with it on a off platform rental when I screwed up the code expiration date for the 2-week stay and the lock had only set it for one week stay



[deleted] • 4mo ago

Yale. It's a star player with no problems - ever.



GlassLakeProperties • 4mo ago

Just had a schlage lock had a system reset/failure resulting in disconnecting our remote access. We had guests over the holidays.. we use hospitable to manage the dual calendar, automated messaging, etc. Hospitable also programs the locks. When the lock code creation failed (using the last 4 of their cell #),

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Pretty cool that it fixed it for me. I also have manual supra punch code boxes on site...at least 2 layers of back up for a lock failure.

I'll go and reset in person once we are through the holidays.



Justanobserver2life • 4mo ago

I'm a guest who had difficulty because we were inadvertently checking in at 3:59 instead of 4:00 pm. But it was confusing in the moment. Realized that it must have some timer associated with it and tried it again a minute later and it worked. So if you don't really care that much whether they open the door a minute, 5 min or 15 min early, set it up to start working just a bit ahead of the check in time to avoid this



kittywings1975 • 4mo ago

I have the Schlage Encode Plus and I really like it. The only thing I don't like about it is that if you press somewhere on the pad to wake it up (the numbers are nearly invisible otherwise) it counts that touch as an input and your code will be incorrect. Amazingly, our guests don't seem to have an issue with it, it's only what I noticed. I'm guessing maybe Airbnb explains it when they send the automatic code. 🙄